



EVERPEACE COMPANIONSHIP
NOT-FOR-PROFIT CORPORATION · OTTAWA, ONTARIO, CANADA

Volunteer Agreement

“Adopt a Muslim Senior” Program · EP-01 · Version 2.0 · August 2026

This Volunteer Agreement (the “Agreement”) is entered into between Everpeace Companionship (the “Organization”), a not-for-profit corporation incorporated in the Province of Ontario under the Not-for-Profit Corporations Act, 2010 (Ontario) (ONCA), and the volunteer identified below (the “Volunteer”). By signing this Agreement, the Volunteer agrees to be bound by all of its terms, as well as the Volunteer Code of Conduct (Appendix C) and the Volunteer Waiver and Release, each of which forms part of this Agreement.

VOLUNTEER INFORMATION

FULL LEGAL NAME OF VOLUNTEER

DATE

TELEPHONE NUMBER

EMAIL ADDRESS

1. SCOPE OF VOLUNTEER DUTIES

The Volunteer agrees to perform the following duties in connection with the Organization’s “Adopt a Muslim Senior” program, as directed by the Executive Director or designated Sector Coordinator:

- (a) Conduct scheduled in-person companionship visits with Muslim seniors residing in long-term care facilities and retirement residences in the Ottawa area, as assigned by the Organization;
- (b) Provide warm social interaction, meaningful conversation, and emotional support during visits, adapted to each senior’s language, cultural background, and personal preferences;
- (c) Participate in cultural, recreational, or faith-based activities with seniors where appropriate and as agreed with the senior and their care team;

- (d) Demonstrate cultural humility during all interactions, in accordance with Section 2 of this Agreement and the Volunteer Code of Conduct;
- (e) Submit a written visit report through the Organization's Volunteer Portal within 24 hours of each completed visit;
- (f) Attend volunteer orientation, training, and check-in sessions as required by the Organization;
- (g) Adhere strictly to the limits of the companionship role: the Volunteer shall not (i) provide personal care, medication administration, medical advice, nursing care, personal support work, or any other regulated health or personal support service; (ii) accept or request any financial benefit from a senior or their family under any circumstances; (iii) provide professional advice of any nature (legal, financial, medical, or otherwise); or (iv) engage in private visits or personal arrangements with seniors outside the scope of the program; and
- (h) Perform any other duties reasonably assigned by the Organization that are consistent with the companionship mandate of the program.

IMPORTANT REMINDERS FOR EVERY VISIT

- Keep the visit respectful, warm, culturally sensitive, and appropriate in duration.
- Follow all infection control guidelines posted on the door; speak to facility staff before entering if unsure.
- Do not wear or bring scented products to a care facility.
- Respect the privacy, rest, and recovery needs of the senior's roommate.
- Children under 14 must be supervised by an accompanying adult at all times — not by the senior.
- If any issue arises or you cannot attend, inform the Organization as soon as possible.
- Last-minute cancellations: NO. Spontaneous unscheduled visits: NO. Any payments from seniors: NO.
- Your presence and companionship are what matter most.

2. CULTURAL HUMILITY

The Volunteer acknowledges that Everpeace Companionship serves Muslim seniors from diverse national, linguistic, cultural, and generational backgrounds, and that the diversity within our community is itself a richness to be honoured. In all volunteer activities, the Volunteer agrees to:

- (a) Approach each senior with an open mind, setting aside preconceptions about how a senior should live, communicate, or observe their faith — including assumptions that may arise from sharing the same faith community;

- (b)** Recognize that the Volunteer's role is to accompany and listen — not to advise, correct, teach, or redirect — and that each senior's autonomy, dignity, and self-determination are paramount at all times;
- (c)** Refrain from making assumptions about a senior's preferences, beliefs, or needs based on their age, country of origin, language, or level of religious observance;
- (d)** Be open to different perspectives on daily life, religious practice, and family values without imposing the Volunteer's own framework; recognize that the way the Volunteer thinks or does things may not be universally applicable;
- (e)** Avoid paternalism and refrain from positioning the volunteer role as a form of rescue: the elders served by this program carry a lifetime of wisdom, resilience, and faith; the Volunteer's presence is an act of respectful service;
- (f)** Actively listen and observe before drawing conclusions, and follow the senior's lead on the nature, topics, and pace of each visit;
- (g)** Respect cultural and generational boundaries, particularly around religious practice, family matters, personal history, and topics the senior does not wish to discuss; and
- (h)** Seek guidance from the designated Sector Coordinator or the Executive Director without delay when uncertain about how to navigate a culturally sensitive situation.

3. UNPAID VOLUNTEER STATUS

The Volunteer acknowledges and agrees that:

- (a)** their service to the Organization is provided entirely on a voluntary and unpaid basis;
- (b)** this Agreement does not create an employment relationship between the Volunteer and the Organization;
- (c)** the Volunteer is not entitled to wages, salary, statutory benefits, or any other remuneration for their volunteer activities;
- (d)** this Agreement does not give rise to an employment relationship for the purposes of the Employment Standards Act, 2000 (Ontario), the Labour Relations Act, 1995 (Ontario), or any other applicable legislation; and
- (e)** volunteer activities do not constitute employment for income tax purposes, and no T4 slip or other employment income slip will be issued by the Organization.

Reasonable out-of-pocket expenses incurred in the course of approved volunteer duties may be reimbursed by the Organization where approved in advance and in writing by the Executive Director.

4. CONFIDENTIALITY

In the course of their volunteer duties, the Volunteer may receive or have access to personal information about seniors, their families, other volunteers, and other individuals ("Confidential Information"). The Volunteer agrees that:

- (a) all Confidential Information is strictly confidential and shall not be disclosed to any person — including the Volunteer’s own family members and friends — without the prior written consent of the Organization, except as required by applicable law;
- (b) “Confidential Information” includes, without limitation: the identity, contact information, health status, personal circumstances, and visit history of any senior or participant; the identity of other volunteers; and any records, communications, or data maintained by the Organization;
- (c) the Volunteer shall take all reasonable steps to protect Confidential Information from unauthorized access, use, or disclosure;
- (d) this confidentiality obligation survives the termination of this Agreement and continues indefinitely; and
- (e) the Volunteer shall promptly notify the Executive Director in writing if they become aware of any actual or potential unauthorized disclosure of confidential information.

5. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

- (a) Any materials, content, or works created by the Volunteer in the course of their volunteer duties — including photographs, written content, social media posts, reports, or other communications produced for or on behalf of the Organization — shall be the sole and exclusive property of the Organization from the moment of creation.
- (b) The Volunteer hereby assigns to the Organization all intellectual property rights (including copyright) in any such materials, and waives any moral rights therein to the fullest extent permitted by applicable law.

6. TERMINATION

- (a) Either party may terminate this Agreement at any time, for any reason or no reason, with or without advance notice.
- (b) The Organization may immediately suspend or terminate the Volunteer’s participation in circumstances including, but not limited to: a breach of this Agreement or any Organization policy; conduct that is or may be harmful to a senior or any other person; violation of the Volunteer Code of Conduct; or any situation that, in the Organization’s reasonable judgment, requires immediate action to protect participants or the Organization’s interests.
- (c) Upon termination of this Agreement for any reason, the Volunteer shall immediately: return any property belonging to the Organization; cease all use and disclosure of Confidential Information; and cooperate with any transition activities reasonably requested by the Organization.

7. INSURANCE DISCLOSURE

- (a) The Organization does not currently maintain insurance coverage for volunteers with respect to personal injury, property damage, or third-party liability arising from volunteer activities.
- (b) The Volunteer is strongly encouraged to review their own personal insurance coverage — including homeowner's, renter's, automobile, and personal liability insurance — and to obtain any supplemental coverage they consider appropriate before participating in the program.
- (c) The Organization makes no representation or warranty that any insurance coverage will be available to the Volunteer, or will respond to any claim arising from their volunteer activities.

8. LIMITATION OF LIABILITY AND INDEMNITY

- (a) To the fullest extent permitted by applicable law, the Volunteer agrees to indemnify, defend, and hold harmless the Organization, its directors, officers, employees, and other volunteers from and against any and all claims, losses, damages, costs, and expenses (including reasonable legal fees) arising out of or relating to: (i) the Volunteer's acts or omissions in the course of their volunteer duties; (ii) any breach by the Volunteer of this Agreement or any Organization policy; or (iii) the Volunteer's negligence or wilful misconduct.
- (b) This indemnity does not apply to claims arising solely from the Organization's own gross negligence or wilful misconduct.

9. GENERAL PROVISIONS

- (a) **Governing Law.** This Agreement is governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the Province of Ontario and the applicable laws of Canada. Any dispute arising from or relating to this Agreement shall be subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of the courts of the City of Ottawa, Ontario.
 - (b) **Entire Agreement.** This Agreement, together with the Volunteer Code of Conduct (Appendix C) and the Volunteer Waiver and Release, constitutes the entire agreement between the parties with respect to the Volunteer's service and supersedes all prior representations, discussions, and understandings, whether oral or written.
 - (c) **Amendment.** No amendment to this Agreement is binding unless made in writing and signed by both parties.
 - (d) **Severability.** If any provision of this Agreement is held by a court of competent jurisdiction to be invalid, illegal, or unenforceable, the remaining provisions shall continue in full force and effect.
 - (e) **Independent Legal Advice.** The Volunteer acknowledges that they have had the opportunity to seek independent legal advice before signing this Agreement, that they have read and understood its contents, and that they are signing it voluntarily and without duress.
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SIGNATURES

FOR EVERPEACE COMPANIONSHIP

AUTHORIZED SIGNATORY — NAME (PRINT)

TITLE / ROLE

SIGNATURE

DATE SIGNED

VOLUNTEER

FULL NAME (PRINT)

DATE SIGNED

SIGNATURE

If the volunteer is under the age of 18, a parent or legal guardian must also sign below.

PARENT / GUARDIAN FULL
NAME (PRINT)

PARENT / GUARDIAN
SIGNATURE

DATE

OPTIONAL WITNESS TO VOLUNTEER SIGNATURE

A witness is not legally required but is recommended for evidentiary purposes.

WITNESS FULL NAME (PRINT)

WITNESS SIGNATURE

DATE